

THE FILMING DAY GUIDE

Built for Mac Czar, Spark Electrical Services

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Read this first (2 minutes)

Mac, you're about to film the stuff that makes your phone ring. Here's the good news: **there is no script to memorize**. All you're doing is answering questions about your own work. You already know every answer.

This covers two things:

1. **The short ads**. 5 to 7 clips, 30 to 60 seconds each. These run on Facebook and Instagram next to the panel ads we built from your crew photos. A real owner on camera beats any graphic we can make.
2. **The sales video (VSL)**. One longer video, 2 to 4 minutes. This sits on your quote page and does the convincing before anyone calls.

You can do this with your phone. Some of the best-performing videos on landing pages like yours are 3-minute webcam recordings. Done beats perfect, every time.

How the session runs (about 60 minutes)

John runs it as the prompter, on a video call or in person. His job: read you one prompt at a time, keep you on topic, and make you redo your opening line once. That's it. Bring Landon if you want, two faces work great, and Danielle can prompt if John's remote.

Time	What's happening
First 10 min	Warm up. Talk about your best recent job and the worst wiring horror story you've opened up. Camera off.
Next 25 min	Film the ads. One idea at a time, from the prompt list below.
Next 15 min	Film the sales video. Question and answer style.
Next 5 min	The job stories video (easiest one, see Part 3).
Last 5 min	B-roll. The crew, the vans, the work.

PART 1: THE SHORT ADS

The only rule: think about your first sentence, then just talk

Every ad has three beats:

Beat 1: Stop the right homeowner from scrolling. Your first sentence. It's the only part worth thinking about before the camera rolls. Take 5 seconds, get it in your head, then go. Say what you do and the result they want.

Weak: "Hi, we're an electrical company in Red Deer." Strong: "Hot tub, EV charger, air conditioning. If you're adding any of those, your panel's probably already full."

Beat 2: Keep talking for about 30 seconds. No script. Stay on the one topic. What confuses people, what you do differently, what happened on a real job last month.

Beat 3: Land the plane. "If that sounds like your place, hit the button below and we'll take a look." Done.

The retake rule

Always redo your first take. Not because it was bad. Because the second one is always better. Everyone's second take wins. Plan on it.

YOUR PROMPT LIST (filmed one at a time, in this order)

1. **The full panel.** Your own line: everyone's adding AC, hot tubs, EV chargers, and the panel's run out of room. Talk about what a 200-amp upgrade actually involves and what the free panel check tells them.
2. **Aluminum wiring and the insurance letter.** The homeowner who found out at renewal time their insurance wants the aluminum wiring dealt with. What that letter means, what the fix looks like, why it's not the disaster they think.
3. **The flickering light.** Everybody ignores it. Tell them what it can mean, when it's nothing, and when it's the warning worth taking.
4. **The breaker that keeps tripping.** Everyone just resets it and hopes. What it's actually telling them.
5. **Getting clicks but no callbacks.** Talk to the homeowner who called two electricians and never heard back. What happens when someone contacts Spark: a real answer, fast, and a quote that shows up.
6. **The thing homeowners always get wrong about electrical.** Your pick. The myth you and Landon correct most often.
7. **Why a young company outworks the old guard.** You're growing fast for a reason. Talk about what Spark does that the established shops stopped bothering with. No trash talk, just the difference.
8. **Hail Mary close-out:** in about 60 seconds, explain what Spark does, who you do it for, and why someone in Red Deer, Sylvan Lake, Blackfalds, Innisfail or anywhere in central Alberta should call you.

Same idea can become two ads. "Your panel's full" and "thinking about an EV charger?" are the same message pointed at different people. If John asks you to say the same thing a different way, that's why.

PART 2: THE SALES VIDEO (VSL)

It's an interview. John asks, you answer, the questions get cut out in the edit. Only the first answer needs any practice.

1. The opener (the only part to run twice before filming). Shape, in your words: *"If you're a homeowner around Red Deer adding a hot tub, an EV charger or AC, and you're not sure your panel can take it, or you've called electricians who never called back, you're who we built this for. I'm Mac, owner of Spark Electrical, and here's how we make sure it's done right, on time, the first time."* Your job photos and crew shots get flashed on screen while you say it.

2. How you work. - What have your customers usually tried before they call you, and why did it let them down? - What's the first thing Spark does on every job? (The honest assessment, the real quote, no surprise extras.) - What do most electrical companies skip after the job that you don't? - Then wrap it: "So, two things. First we [step one]. Then we [step two]."

3. The questions you hear on every single quote. Most common first. How fast can you come out, what does a 200-amp upgrade roughly involve, do you handle the permit, what about the aluminum wiring insurance paperwork. For results, say what customers tell you afterwards in their own words.

4. Who you are (15 seconds, said for their benefit). Keep it honest and concrete: *"Because I'm a certified Master Electrician, fully insured and WCB covered, and our crew's done hundreds of jobs across central Alberta, you're not the test run. Every job gets the owner's eyes on it."* (If you want to add years in the trade, use your real number on camera.)

5. The close. *"So if you want power that keeps up with your house, and you're done with electricians who don't call back, fill out the short form below or give us a call. We'll tell you straight if it's a job for us."*

Two things to leave OUT: your prices, and anything you can't back up on your worst week.

PART 3: THE JOB STORIES VIDEO (3 minutes, easiest win of the day)

Pull up photos of three or four jobs you're proud of. Hit record with your face in the corner and walk through them:

"This one's a 200-amp upgrade in Sylvan Lake. When we opened the old panel, here's what we found..."

Two or three minutes, done. No prep, no polish. This earns its spot on your quote page and takes less time than your coffee break.

(As your Google reviews stack up through the review system, we'll refilm this one scrolling through real reviews. That version's even stronger. For now, the job stories do the same work.)

PART 4: B-ROLL SHOT LIST

Grab 10 to 20 seconds of each:

- You or the crew walking a jobsite (toward camera, phone steady)
 - The vans, Spark branding visible
 - The crew working, real work, not posed (we already have your website photos, fresh moving footage beats stills)
 - Close-ups: hands in a panel, the labeled breakers after a tidy job, a finished EV charger install
 - Before and after of a panel swap or aluminum wiring fix
 - **The landmark shot:** you in front of something everyone in Red Deer knows. Gaetz Avenue, the main drag, your shop. Locals trust faces they see in places they recognize.
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IF YOU'RE USING A VIDEOGRAPHER: TECH SPECS (hand them this page)

Formats: Shoot everything in 4K. Frame the ads and the job stories video **vertical (9:16)**, safe for Reels and Stories. Shoot the VSL **horizontal (16:9)**, framed center so a vertical crop works too. If shooting one format only, go vertical for ads, horizontal for the VSL.

Audio: Lav mic on Mac. Clean audio is non-negotiable, it matters more than the picture. No music on raw files.

Light: Daylight, sun on the face, never behind. Outside beats inside. Golden hour if the schedule allows, but don't chase it at the cost of the session.

First frame: For at least a few ad takes, put trust in the background of the opening shot: the vans, the crew, or an active jobsite. If a customer testimonial gets filmed at any point, hold a cutaway or split screen of Mac in the first 3 seconds so viewers connect the face to the business.

Direction style: You are the prompter. Feed one idea at a time from the prompt list. Let him talk past stumbles, do not stop takes for small flubs. Always run the opener twice. If an answer ran long, ask "say that again, shorter." Keep him standing and moving, a still body makes a flat voice.

Delivery: Raw, ungraded files. Separate audio track if recorded. WeTransfer or Drive link to John at Apex. The edit, captions, and cutdowns are handled on the Apex side.

IF SOMEONE ELSE IS EDITING: WHAT THE FINISHED VIDEOS SHOULD LOOK LIKE

Default is simple: send raw files to John and the edit gets done for you. But if your videographer or an editor is cutting these, hand them this page. John sends 1 or 2 reference clips with the prompt list so everyone can see the target before cutting.

The short ads (30 to 60 seconds, vertical 9:16): - Open on the strongest take of the first sentence. The hook also goes on screen as big text for the first 3 seconds. - Tighten with jump cuts and punch-ins. A 3 minute raw take should cut to 30 to 60 seconds. Cut the dead air, keep the energy. - **Captions burned in, always.** Most people watch with the sound off. Big, readable, high contrast, and kept out of the bottom fifth of the frame so app buttons don't cover them. - Keep it human. Leave the small stumbles and the ums in. If it gets polished to news anchor smooth, it stops working. Cut mistakes, not personality. - End card, 2 to 3 seconds: the SPARK amber logo on black, "Get your free quote" and the website or phone number. - No stock footage, no AI imagery, no cheesy transitions. Real footage only.

The sales video (VSL, horizontal 16:9, 2 to 4 minutes): - Cut the prompter's questions out so it plays as Mac talking straight to the homeowner. - **Spend most of the editing effort on the first 30 seconds.** While Mac runs the opener, flash proof on screen: real job photos, the crew shots from the website, before and afters. The rest of the video can stay almost bare. - Layer B-roll over the talking wherever it matches what's being said. Talking head alone is fine for the back half. - Captions on, same rules as the ads. - Light background music is fine here, kept low. None on the ads. - Thumbnail: pick the most visually engaging working moment, not a frozen mid-word face.

The job stories video: - Captions burned in. That's the whole edit. Keep it raw, that's why it works.

Brand basics: Spark amber (#f5bb23) for text highlights and the end card, white text on dark backgrounds. Logo small in a corner or on the end card only, never plastered over the footage.

OWNER'S CHECKLIST FOR THE DAY

- Phone charged, lens wiped
- Wear what you wear to work. Spark shirt if you have one. Don't dress up
- Location: the shop or an active jobsite. Outside, sun on your face
- Quiet enough to talk without shouting
- Landon if he's keen, coffee either way

Mess up a line? Say it again. Nobody ever sees the bad takes.

Questions before the shoot? Text John.